What's new

A suspicious conference

Terence Tao · 17 April 2025

https://terrytao.wordpress.com/2025/04/17/a-suspicious-conference/

tao2typ · converted to Typst 2026-10-14 (UTC)

I have received multiple queries from colleagues who have been invited (from a non-academic email address) to speak a strange-sounding conference that is allegedly supported by major mathematical institutions, allegedly hosted at a prestigious university, and allegedly having myself (and two other Fields Medalists) as plenary speakers. The invitees are asked to pay "registration fees" upfront, with the promise of future reimbursement. (There is a bare-bones web site, which seems to be partially copy-pasted from some previous "conferences" in chemistry and physics, but I will not link to it here.)

I have not agreed (or even been asked) to participate in this event, and I can confirm the same for at least one of the other supposed plenary speakers. There is also no confirmation of the support or location claimed.

As such, this does not appear to be a legitimate scientific conference, and I would advise anyone receiving such an email to discard it.

EDIT: in order to have this post be picked up by appropriate search engine queries, the name of the alleged conference is "Infinity '25: Horizons in Mathematical Thought".

SECOND EDIT: I am *not* referring to the 2026 International Congress of Mathematicians (ICM), which is also sending out speaker invitations currently, and is of course an extremely legitimate conference.

Comments (8)

Anonymous · 17 April 2025

It is quite easy to generate the concept and the website for a scam conference using AI. There will always be people who do not identify it as scam and pay, and you get away with that.

It is further not difficult to send emails from an arbitrary address – it was a mistake by the scammers they did not do so.

Besides big names, a nice location is another magnet for people to register.

Guanyuming He · 17 April 2025

Dear Prof. Tao,

If it turns out to be a scam, what do you think could be the intentions behind it, other than obtaining money by fraud? Also, are such suspicious events common?

Thank you for your time in advance.
Best,
Guanyuming He

Anonymous · 17 April 2025

Dear Guanyuming He, the scammers also get a list of people who are interested in the "conference", which can be used to target them in the future, and can also be onsold to other scammers.

Anonymous · 19 April 2025

There is another near clone conference website for a conference in San Francisco in 2025 titled "Physics Applications Conference: Where Theory meets Reality". Several of the pictures of the venue are identical to the ones for the venue in England…

Anonymous · 23 April 2025

News of this conference has reached us at Cambridge in the maths dept. It is fake. I'm glad you've already written this blog piece. I have reported the site to the University (as they are using the crest without permission on invitation letters) and the national cyber security conference in the UK.

Anonymous · 27 April 2025

The website's registration page states that the early bird registration deadline was Feb. 28, but a quick whois lookup shows the domain wasn't registered until Apr. 12.

Anonymous · 29 April 2025

Yeah, I also fall for such things, i.e. answering these emails and then be proceeded to some poorly made pay website. I guess, these things will only get worse to spot through using modern generative tools.

Anonymous · 19 May 2025

It looks like they are back:
https://axisconference.org